



FREE GUIDE · FOR OPHTHALMOLOGY

The Ophthalmology Practice's Guide to Compliant Disposal.

Intravitreal injections, surgical sharps, and
expired drugs — every stream, handled right.

DEA-REGISTERED

EPA-COMPLIANT

NO CONTRACT

CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Compliance, made simple.

Clinic plus surgery.

Ophthalmology combines clinic and surgical care — cataract and other procedures, and intravitreal injections that run at real volume — so you generate surgical and injection sharps, expired injectable drugs, and biohazard well beyond an optometry office. This guide covers every stream.

The good news

One vendor can take your injection and surgical sharps, expired injectables, and biohazard — by prepaid mail-back kit or scheduled pickup — with a Certificate of Destruction and no contract.

AT A GLANCE

Who regulates what.

Agency	What it covers in your practice
OSHA	Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — sharps handling, containers, and annual staff training.
EPA	RCRA — hazardous pharmaceutical waste identification, segregation, and destruction.
DEA	Controlled substances — non-retrievable destruction and DEA Form 41 documentation.
DOT	Safe shipping of regulated medical and pharmaceutical waste in transit.
State	Health-department and environmental rules that vary by state.

THE STREAMS

Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream your practice produces — what belongs in it, what does not, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to stay clean.

WASTE STREAM 01

Sharps

Intravitreal injection and surgical sharps.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Intravitreal injection needles
- Surgical blades & needles
- Syringes & cannulas

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Bloody gauze (biohazard)
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)
- Non-sharp packaging

THE RULE · OSHA Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — FDA-cleared, puncture-resistant containers, no overfilling, annual training.

DISPOSE WITH · Sharps mail-back kit.

Tip

Replace containers at the fill line; keep them upright, closable, and out of reach.

WASTE STREAM 02

Pharmaceutical waste

Expired injectable drugs and anesthetics.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired anti-VEGF & injectables
- Topical & injectable anesthetics
- Other expired non-controlled meds

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Controlled substances (own kit)
- RCRA-hazardous drugs (own kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · Do not drain-dispose; segregate hazardous and controlled drugs; destroy with documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Pharmaceutical waste mail-back kit.

Tip

Segregate hazardous and controlled drugs first — everything else routes here.

WASTE STREAM 03

Biohazard / regulated medical waste

Surgical and procedure regulated waste.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Surgical & procedure biohazard
- Blood-soaked materials
- Contaminated PPE

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Sharps (sharps kit)
- Lightly soiled everyday items
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)

THE RULE · OSHA plus your state's medical-waste rules — red bags, labeling, treatment/destruction, retained documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Biohazard mail-back kit.

Tip

Only visibly blood/OPIM-contaminated items are red-bag waste — check your state's definition.

WASTE STREAM 04

Controlled substances

If you use sedation for procedures.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired / unused Schedule II-V sedatives
- Wasted & partial doses
- Surrendered controlled stock

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-controlled meds (pharmaceutical kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · DEA — render non-retrievable, DEA Form 41 for surrendered controls, witnessed logs.

DISPOSE WITH · Controlled / medication mail-back kit, to DEA standards.

Tip

Log and witness every wasted controlled dose — the DEA checks the paper trail.

YOUR CHECKLIST

The ophthalmology compliance checklist.

- ☐ Intravitreal and surgical sharps in FDA-cleared containers, sized to injection volume.
- ☐ Expired injectable drugs (anti-VEGF, anesthetics) destroyed as pharmaceutical waste.
- ☐ Surgical and procedure biohazard red-bagged and destroyed.

- ☐ Any sedation controls non-retrievable with a Form 41.
- ☐ Staff trained annually on OSHA bloodborne pathogens.
- ☐ Certificates of Destruction retained per your state's rules.

QUESTIONS OPHTHALMOLOGISTS ASK

Your ophthalmology questions, answered.

How do we handle the volume of intravitreal injection sharps?

Injection-heavy clinics generate real sharps volume — we size your kits so containers never overfill.

What do we do with expired anti-VEGF or injectable drugs?

As pharmaceutical waste — destroyed with documentation, not flushed.

Is surgical waste handled differently than clinic waste?

Surgical sharps and biohazard follow the same compliant paths; higher volume may favor scheduled pickup — we'll size it.

Do we need a contract?

No — no contract, no minimums.

THE EASY WAY

Handle it with mail-back.

Easy Rx Cycle ships prepaid mail-back kits (or scheduled pickup for surgical volume) sized to an ophthalmology practice — injection and surgical sharps, expired injectables, and biohazard — with a Certificate of Destruction. No contract.

QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

Waste stream	The right path
Injection & surgical sharps	Sharps mail-back kit
Expired injectable drugs	Pharmaceutical waste kit
Surgical biohazard	Biohazard mail-back kit
Sedation controls (if any)	Controlled / medication kit (Form 41)



Prefer pickup, or higher volume?

Higher surgical volume may favor scheduled pickup over mail-back — we'll size it. Get a quote at easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote or call 501-904-2929.

WHY OPHTHALMOLOGY PRACTICES CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE

- No contract, no minimums — buy as you need
- Flat-rate pricing — no fuel or hidden surcharges
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- DEA-registered, EPA- & OSHA-aligned destruction
- A Certificate of Destruction on every single order

Ready to simplify your ophthalmology practice waste?

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract, cancel anytime.

501-904-2929 · sales@easyrxcycle.com · easyrxcycle.com/shop